

Indie Hacker Growth Guide

5 Zero-Budget Strategies

Proven growth tactics for makers, indie hackers, and solo founders. No ad spend required.

1. SEO for Indie Products

Target long-tail keywords with low competition. Write 10 deep-dive guides solving specific user problems. Each post gets schema markup, internal links, and a clear CTA to your product.

Quick wins: fix title tags, add meta descriptions, submit sitemap to GSC. Use AnswerThePublic for question-based keyword ideas. Low-competition terms let indie products win without big budgets.

2. Build in Public

Share your journey daily on X (Twitter), LinkedIn, or Mastodon. Post metrics, learnings, and launches weekly.

Formula: what you learned + what you built + what happened. Launch on Product Hunt, HN, and subreddits.

Build-in-public accounts grow 3x faster than faceless brands.

3. Content Repurposing

One asset becomes five. Blog post -> 5 tweets -> 1 LinkedIn post -> 1 newsletter -> 1 video script.

Use Canva for graphics, OBS for recording, AI for reformatting. Repurposing costs 20% of the effort for 80% of the reach. Your best content is under-distributed.

4. Community-Led Growth

Join 3 communities where your users hang out. Answer questions for 30 days before sharing your product.

Best: Indie Hackers, Maker Mag, MicroConf, relevant subreddits, niche Discords. Give value first. When you eventually share, people trust you because you helped them.

5. Email List from Day 1

Start before launch. Use MailerLite, Buttondown, or ConvertKit (all free at low volume).

Lead magnet: checklist, template, or mini-guide. Send weekly. Target 500 subscribers in 90 days. Email converts 5-10x better than social for launches

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